

Day 4 — Using AI for Strategy & Research Summaries

Activity packet for participant triads. Today's job: take the Week-1 prompt patterns and use them at **strategy scale** — multi-source synthesis with traceable evidence — to produce a strategy brief for your FieldPulse problem.

Where we are in the week

Week 1 taught prompting. Days 1–3 of Week 2 produced metrics, a North Star, and design principles. Today the triads use AI to **compile, summarize, and stress-test secondary research** — the kind of work that, done by hand, eats a TPM's full week.

Triads end the day with an **AI-Assembled Strategy Brief** that integrates everything from Week 1 forward. It's the input to Friday's journey-mapping work.

Inputs

- The triad's NS Defense Card, Tier Sheet, and 3 design principles (Days 1–3)
- The triad's Week-1 problem statement and Prompt Pattern Library
- The **FieldPulse Research Pack** (handouts):
 - 3 anonymized dispatcher interview transcripts (~5 pages each)
 - 14 support tickets (already used Day 4 of Week 1)
 - 1 industry analyst report (5 pages)
 - 2 competitor product tour transcripts
 - 1 internal "voice of customer" Slack export (33 messages)

The Research Pack is realistic: noisy, redundant, partly contradictory. That's the point.

The day's keeper artifact: the Strategy Brief

Each triad ends the day with a 2–3 page **AI-Assembled Strategy Brief**. The template:

```

# Strategy Brief – <Problem area>
**Triad:** <names> | **NS:** <one line>

## Executive summary (5 bullets max, hand-written)
...

## Top 5 user pain themes (AI-summarized, evidence-tagged)
For each theme:
- **Theme:** <verb-based statement>
- **Evidence:** <source citations, e.g., "Interview A3, C2; Tickets T-04, T-11;
  #voice-of-customer 2025-09-12">
- **Confidence:** H / M / L
- **AI-generated?** Y/N (if Y: which prompt + what we did to validate)

## Competitive snapshot (AI-drafted, hand-edited)
| Competitor | Strength | Weakness | Where they beat us |
|-----|-----|-----|-----|

## Strategy implications (hand-written)
- What our NS implies for these themes
- Which design principle from Day 3 most directly addresses each theme
- One open question we still need humans for

## Provenance log
- Prompts used: link to triad's Pattern Library entries
- Manual validation steps taken
- Where the AI was wrong (named openly)

```

The **Provenance log** is mandatory. A strategy brief without it is fiction.

Activity 1 — Multi-source Synthesis Drill

Format: Triad • 35 min • Block 1

Purpose

Practice the **summarize-with-evidence-tags** pattern at scale before applying it to the real research pack.

Setup

Each triad gets a small "warm-up pack": **2 interview transcripts + 4 tickets** (from a different domain than FieldPulse — healthcare scheduling, to force generalization).

Steps

1. **Single-prompt attempt** (10 min). One member writes a single prompt that asks the AI to extract top 5 themes with evidence citations from the warm-up pack. Run it.
2. **Inspect the output** (10 min). For each theme:
 - o Did the AI cite real sources or invent them?
 - o Did themes get over-generalized into mush?
 - o Are any themes missing that you spotted yourself reading?
3. **Iterate the prompt** (15 min). Add one constraint per failure mode. Re-run. Compare.

Deliverable

A **two-paragraph diagnosis** of the failure modes the triad observed, plus the iterated prompt that worked.

Activity 2 — The Research Pack Pass

Format: Triad • 40 min • Block 2

Purpose

Apply the iterated prompt pattern to the **real FieldPulse Research Pack** and produce the first draft of the Pain Themes section.

Setup

Each triad has its iterated prompt from Activity 1, the FieldPulse Research Pack, and AI assistant access (with the ability to split large pastes into multiple calls).

Steps

1. **Pre-flight** (5 min). Re-read your iterated prompt from Activity 1. Confirm it includes:
 - Role
 - Context (what problem you're investigating)
 - Constraints (must cite source material; flag inferred themes)
 - Format (theme / evidence / confidence / AI-flag)
2. **Run** (15 min). Feed the Research Pack chunks into the AI. Note: most tools have a context limit — split the pack into 2–3 calls.
3. **Cross-validate** (15 min). Each member takes a different theme and verifies *every* citation against the source. Mark any that fail.
4. **Edit** (5 min). Cut themes with failed citations. Lower confidence on inferred themes.

What "good" looks like for this output

- 5 themes (no fewer; the AI will naturally lump)
- Every theme cites at least 2 distinct sources
- No more than 1 theme is AI-only (no observed evidence) — and it's flagged as a hypothesis to validate
- Themes are verbs, not categories ("Cannot reconcile mid-route" beats "Reconcile UX")

Deliverable

5 pain themes with citations, confidence ratings, and AI-flag — ready to drop into the Strategy Brief's Pain Themes section.

Activity 3 — Competitive Snapshot

Format: Triad • 40 min • Block 3

Purpose

Use AI to do the most defensible part of competitive research: **structuring** information you already have access to. This is also the failure mode the AI is most frequently used for *poorly* — generating fake market data.

Setup

Each triad has the competitor materials from the Research Pack (2 product tour transcripts + public pricing pages) and AI assistant access.

The bright line

AI can summarize and structure source material you provide. AI cannot tell you what your competitors actually do.

The triad's two prompts

Prompt 1 — "Structure what we know" (safe):

```
Role: Competitive analyst.
Context: I'm pasting in two competitor product tour transcripts (ServiceTitan,
Housecall Pro) plus their public pricing pages.
Task: Structure into a comparison matrix.
Constraints:
  - Only use facts from the materials I pasted; do not pull from your training data
  - Flag any cell where the source is silent (do not infer)
Format: Markdown table – Feature / ServiceTitan / Housecall Pro / Source citation
```

Prompt 2 — "Tell us what's missing" (also safe):

```
Continuing from above. Now: looking at the matrix you just built,
what are the THREE most important questions about these competitors
that the source materials do NOT answer? For each, suggest where a
TPM should look (analyst reports, customer interviews, public earnings calls).
```

What NOT to ask

- "What is ServiceTitan's market share?"
- "Who is the leader in dispatch SaaS?"
- "Cite a study showing dispatcher productivity gains"

These will be confidently fabricated.

Deliverable

A clean **Competitive Snapshot** (matrix + open questions) added to the Strategy Brief.

Activity 4 — Brief Assembly + Provenance Log

Format: Triad • 45 min + Readouts • Block 4

Purpose

Stitch the day's outputs into a single strategy brief, write the executive summary by hand, and complete the provenance log.

Setup

Each triad has all the day's outputs visible: warm-up diagnosis, 5 pain themes, Competitive Snapshot. Brief template is open in the triad's preferred tool.

Triad protocol

1. **Hand-write the executive summary** (15 min). 5 bullets max. The AI cannot do this — it doesn't know what your audience cares about.
2. **Hand-write the strategy implications** (10 min). What does the NS imply for these themes? Which design principle most directly addresses each?
3. **Complete the provenance log** (10 min). For every AI-generated section:
 - Which prompts (link to Pattern Library)
 - What manual validation was done
 - Where the AI was wrong (named openly — this is the trust-building section)
4. **Polish** (10 min). Brief is shareable: cohort, design partner, engineer would all be able to read it.

Readout structure (90 seconds per triad)

1. "Our top pain theme is [X], cited from [N sources]."
2. "The strongest AI failure we caught was [Y]."
3. "Tomorrow, we expect this brief to drive our journey map by [how]."

Deliverable

A 2–3 page Strategy Brief per triad with hand-written executive summary, AI-assembled pain themes (validated), hand-written strategy implications, and a complete Provenance log including at least one named AI failure.

End-of-day checkpoint

Each triad leaves the day with:

- ✓ An iterated prompt pattern for **multi-source synthesis with evidence**
- ✓ **5 pain themes** with citations and confidence levels
- ✓ A **Competitive Snapshot** built from materials they actually pasted in
- ✓ An **Executive summary + strategy implications** (hand-written)
- ✓ A complete **Provenance log** — including at least one named AI failure